Complete manual — FMODEL AD Health Report 1.0.0

FMODEL - SERVICOS E CONSULTORIA EM TECNOLOGIA DA INFORMAÇÃO

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1. Purpose and scope

Export-ADHealthReport.ps1 turns AD inventory and diagnostics into structured collection with an offline HTML report, CSV and JSON. It supports understanding the environment, preparing technical presentations and reviewing conditions requiring investigation. It is not certification of Active Directory security, compliance, availability or complete functionality.

The tool queries data and writes local files. It does not delete accounts, reset passwords, modify groups, force replication, transfer FSMO roles, change schema/GPO, start/restart services, repair DNS or apply automatic remediation. Queries can generate normal network traffic and authentication/audit events. “Read-only AD collection” does not mean no I/O: reports are written on the computer executing the script.

2. Improvements over the submitted script

The original repeated inventory queries for counts, classified any computer whose operating system did not contain “server” as a workstation, and displayed almost everything only in the console. It also converted schema results through formatted text and recognized DCDiag outcomes using English phrases, which could be misleading on other OS languages.

The new structure preserves usable CSV/JSON data, identifies collection scope/DC, distinguishes missing data from zero and records coverage/errors per collector. Computers missing OS information are not automatically declared workstations. FSMO roles come from AD object properties instead of relying on textual netdom parsing.

Independent checks are not gated by successful ping. Services and DCDiag are optional, and their failures are not isolated proof of a failed DC. Structured replication data complements native diagnostic evidence, whose completion is presented for review rather than declared healthy after matching an English “passed test” phrase.

3. Requirements and permissions

Real operation requires 64-bit Windows, Windows PowerShell 5.1 and the ActiveDirectory/RSAT module. The computer must reach the selected AD environment and authenticate with an authorized account. A management workstation with RSAT is suitable; executing inside a DC is not mandatory. PowerShell 7 is used only for offline tests in this delivery; the operational entry point rejects PowerShell 7.

Elevation is not required by default. Directory reads can work with delegated permissions; replication, CIM or DCDiag can require additional rights. The tool grants none and does not evade ACLs. Do not use Domain Admin merely for convenience when a basic inventory can use narrower approved rights.

The current token is used. No embedded password, API key or credential export is involved. The tool does not install RSAT, enable WinRM, configure TrustedHosts or open firewall rules. DNS, authentication, AD Web Services and protocols required by each check must already be available. Optional CIM collection uses existing WSMan configuration.

4. Download, folder and VSCode

Open scripts/ad-health-report on GitHub, select AD-Health-Report-v1.0.0.zip and click Download raw file, then Extract All. Alternatively use Code → Download ZIP from the repository home, extract it and open scripts/ad-health-report. Git is not required to download.

Open the extracted folder in VSCode through File → Open Folder and select a Windows PowerShell terminal. Trust only code whose origin/content you reviewed. Do not execute within the ZIP or dot-source the entry point; invoke the file by name. Preserve UTF-8 with BOM when editing for Windows PowerShell 5.1.

```
Get-Location
Get-ChildItem
$PSVersionTable
Get-Module -ListAvailable ActiveDirectory
```

Do not append the folder name again if already inside it. If ActiveDirectory is unavailable, obtain/install the appropriate RSAT component through your approved IT process; the script does not install it automatically.

5. Test without contacting a domain

From the tool folder in a normal terminal:

```
powershell.exe -NoProfile -File .\tests\Test-AdHealth.ps1
```

The offline suite also runs with pwsh. It uses synthetic data/adapters without needing a domain, RSAT or Administrator. Automated checks exercise implemented behavior, including data handling and output, but do not prove integration with a real forest.

See EVIDENCE.json for actual tested environments, source version/hashes and limits. Passing a synthetic suite is not operational acceptance in the company's AD environment. Do not load test adapters as command replacements in a production administration session.

6. First real collection

In Windows PowerShell 5.1 with the AD module and read permissions:

```
.\Export-ADHealthReport.ps1
```

Scope defaults to Domain, initially discovered from the executing computer's domain. Select an authorized DC explicitly when necessary:

```
.\Export-ADHealthReport.ps1 -Server dc01.example.com
```

Replace example.com hostnames with real authorized servers. RootDSE identifies the context and its dnsHostName pins the DC. This keeps domain counts/queries from implicitly switching servers for each command.

Execution writes reports. There is no “apply fixes” stage. Do not add parameters from other projects, such as -Apply or -ScopeOverwrite; they are not part of this script.

7. Domain versus forest

Domain collects the selected domain. Forest enumerates forest domains and pins a DC for each domain's queries. Interpret counts together with Domain, Server and Coverage. Domain mode can still display forest metadata such as schema and forest FSMO roles; that does not make its account inventory forest-wide.

```
.\Export-ADHealthReport.ps1 -Scope Forest
```

Failures in a domain do not make remaining counts a reliable complete forest total. Review which domains/collectors succeeded. A pinned DC also represents that DC's view at collection time; this is not a consistent transactional snapshot across every server.

8. Every parameter

Parameter	Default/range	Effect
Server	Not supplied	Initial context; RootDSE dnsHostName pins the DC.
Scope	Domain; Domain/Forest	Selects domain-inventory scope.
OutputPath	LocalApplicationData/FMODEL/ADHealth	Local base for a unique Run-UTC-GUID folder.
InactiveDays	90; 1–3650	Activity-review threshold, subject to lastLogonTimestamp limitations.
IncludeServiceChecks	false	Optional CIM/WSMan service reads.
IncludeDcDiagnostics	false	Optional permitted DCDiag tests.
TimeoutSeconds	60; 5–600	Native-process/CIM-operation timeout, not a global deadline.
MaxHtmlRows	1000; 10–10000	Limits displayed HTML rows, not CSV/JSON.
PageSize	500; 1–1000	Page size for compatible inventory queries.
SkipUserInventory	false	Omits user inventory; coverage records the omission.
SkipPrivilegedMembers	false	Omits direct-member enumeration of selected sensitive groups.
WhatIf	false; common parameter	Performs only initial discovery/output validation, without full inventory or files.
Confirm	PowerShell preference; Low impact	Can request approval for collection/output, not remediation.

SupportsShouldProcess uses Low impact: default execution does not require interactive confirmation. -WhatIf performs only bootstrap (runtime, AD context and path), creates no run folder and does not execute full collection; it returns NotCollected. Initial AD discovery reads still occur.

```
.\Export-ADHealthReport.ps1 -Server dc01.example.com -WhatIf
```

These are collection/presentation options, not remediation switches. Smaller PageSize does not cap total objects; the server continues paging. TimeoutSeconds is not a whole-run deadline for discovery, module loading, LDAP/ADWS, DNS, output or every execution call.

9. Optional services and DCDiag

```
.\Export-ADHealthReport.ps1 -IncludeServiceChecks -IncludeDcDiagnostics
```

NTDS, Netlogon, DNS, KDC, W32Time and DFSR are queried through CIM/WSMan without start, stop or restart. Observation=Observed means a record was returned; NotObserved means no matching record was observed, not a transport failure or a confirmed Stopped state. Missing status, denied access, unavailable transport or timeout require investigation; they do not automatically mean stopped service or offline DC. Whether DNS must run locally depends on DC roles/topology and cannot be decided from the service name alone.

DCDiag uses a restricted test list: NetLogons, Replications, Services, Advertising and KnowsOfRoleHolders, with /q. No /fix, dynamic-DNS-update tests or comprehensive scan with additional effects is requested. The process has its own timeout, captures exit/output and saves raw logs under native. A timed-out process gets a timeout marker; its partial output is not retained. Attempting to terminate it does not turn the result into a completed test.

/q mainly prints error messages. Empty text, exit zero or process completion does not prove complete health. Rows are classified for review, such as CompletedReviewRequired, Timeout or CommandError. English “passed test” phrases are not required. DCDiag's own connectivity test depends on ICMP; successful independent AD queries do not eliminate that native diagnostic limitation.

10. Output files

Output is local to the executing computer under OutputPath. The default uses the current account's LocalApplicationData. OutputPath is a local FileSystem-provider base: relative paths follow the current PowerShell location; UNC, detected network drives and wildcard paths are rejected. Each execution receives its own Run-UTC-GUID folder to avoid mixing reports.

- Report.html: offline dashboard with local search and collected datasets.

- report.json: metadata/technical data, preserving collected values without spreadsheet-specific neutralization.

- A CSV per dataset, comma-delimited with UTF-8 BOM.

- run-manifest.json: SHA256 hashes of artifacts included in the run manifest.

- native/: raw optional diagnostic output when those checks run.

The manifest is generated after other artifacts and does not hash itself. Later-added files, such as a browser-printed PDF, are not automatically included. A manifest helps detect subsequent changes; it is not a digital signature, origin-authenticity attestation or collection-completeness proof. Large environments can generate substantial output. No automatic retention, compression, encryption or deletion policy is imposed on real reports.

11. Datasets and CSV names

Dataset	CSV	Main content
Forest	forest.csv	Forest metadata, schema and forest roles.
Domains	domains.csv	Selected domains, functional mode and metadata.
DomainControllers	domaincontrollers.csv	Discovered DCs, domain, site and available facts.
OrganizationalUnits	organizationalunits.csv	OUs and selected properties.
ComputerSummary	computersummary.csv	Computer-inventory summary.
Computers	computers.csv	Computers and selected review indicators.
Users	users.csv	Users and selected attributes when enabled.
Groups	groups.csv	Groups and selected properties.
PrivilegedMembers	privilegedmembers.csv	Direct memberships in selected sensitive groups.
PasswordPolicies	passwordpolicies.csv	Collected default/fine-grained password policies.
Trusts	trusts.csv	Trust relationships and available properties.
Replication	replication.csv	Structured partner/partition metadata.
ReplicationFailures	replicationfailures.csv	Returned replication failures.
Services	services.csv	Optional service collection results.
NativeDiagnostics	nativediagnostics.csv	Native status, exit and diagnostic reference.
Findings	findings.csv	Findings and recommendations requiring review.
Coverage	coverage.csv	Successful, skipped or unavailable collection.
CollectionErrors	collectionerrors.csv	Per-step/query errors and limitations.

A header-only CSV cannot by itself distinguish no objects from uncollected data. Coverage and CollectionErrors provide that distinction. Do not automatically fill missing data with zero when preparing charts/presentations.

12. HTML search and presentation limits

Open Report.html in a local browser. No CDN, Internet connection or external library is required. Search runs in the browser without sending data or queries to a server. AD/error/native text is encoded so it is not treated as executable markup.

MaxHtmlRows limits presentation only. Browser search reaches content embedded in HTML, not an external full-row database. When a table is reduced, use CSV/JSON to inspect all successfully collected data. Controls expand/collapse sections and print through the browser. Printing does not make diagnostics more complete. Raising the limit can increase memory use and slow the browser; it does not complete failed queries.

13. CSV and formula protection

CSV uses comma delimiters and UTF-8 BOM. If Excel's regional configuration fails to split columns, use Data → From Text/CSV, selecting UTF-8 and comma. Do not assume a semicolon delimiter from the Windows display language.

Potential spreadsheet formulas receive an apostrophe prefix. CSV quoting alone is insufficient to prevent Excel or similar tools from interpreting a formula. This protection can change a value's visible representation; inspect JSON for the collected value without this spreadsheet-specific transformation.

JSON preserves the collected data model, not every original directory/.NET object attribute. It is not an AD backup or restore format. This tool has no data-import or object-replay function.

14. Schema, functional levels and OS

Schema, domain/forest functional mode and DC operating system are separate concepts. The schema number does not establish every server's current OS or update status.

The mapping recognizes schema 88 as introduced with Windows Server 2019 and also used by Windows Server 2022; 91 corresponds to Windows Server 2025. Unknown versions should retain their numeric value for review instead of inventing a classification. A Windows2016Domain functional level does not necessarily mean all DCs run Windows Server 2016.

OperatingSystem and related attributes are directory inventory and may be absent/stale. They do not prove patch inventory, contracted support or live endpoint state. Missing OS information must not automatically turn a computer into a workstation.

15. Activity and account flags

InactiveDays supplies an account-review threshold. lastLogonTimestamp is replicated at a granularity controlled by msDS-LogonTimeSyncInterval and can lag a real logon. LastLogonDate is a convenient representation of that kind of data, not precise evidence of every logon.

lastLogon is maintained independently on each DC and is not replicated. An accurate domain-wide last-logon value requires querying every DC and evaluating those values. Neither that cost nor that result should be assumed here. Missing/zero means unknown, not proof that the account was never used.

PasswordNotRequired is a flag, not proof of a blank password. PasswordNeverExpires, disabled preauthentication, delegation and other reported conditions are contextual review signals. Service accounts, approved exceptions and compensating controls matter. The tool does not read passwords, hashes, LAPS secrets or gMSA key material and never automatically disables an account because of age.

16. Sensitive groups, policies and trusts

Sensitive groups are selected by SID rather than localized names. Selection includes domain Domain Admins; Schema Admins and Enterprise Admins in the forest root domain; and builtin groups such as Administrators, Account Operators, Server Operators and Backup Operators.

PrivilegedMembers enumeration is direct membership only. A nested group can appear as a group, but its users are not automatically expanded. This is not an effective-privilege audit. Primary groups, SIDHistory, delegated ACLs, external principals and cross-forest/resolution failures also limit completeness. adminCount=1 does not prove current privileged membership.

Password-policy inventory does not establish each user's effective policy. Fine-grained policies can override defaults; an individual investigation can require Get-ADUserResultantPasswordPolicy and context analysis. Listed trusts do not establish the safety of every cross-forest access path. No exploitation test or trust modification occurs.

17. Replication and check limitations

Get-ADReplicationPartnerMetadata queries inbound partners across hosted partitions selected by Partition='*'. Get-ADReplicationFailure adds failures associated with the target DC. Results and errors are retained for review; the tool does not force synchronization, recalculate topology or remove connections.

A successful read without returned failures describes the queried view at that moment, not future availability. A single-DC topology can have no replication partners and requires its own interpretation. Insufficient access/network error must not become “zero failures.” Old timestamps and result codes need assessment against replication frequency, site, partition and maintenance context.

18. Overall states, exit and coverage

State	Exit	Interpretation
NotCollected	0	WhatIf or declined confirmation; no run folder.
Completed	0	Collection completed under implemented criteria; not proof of health/compliance.
CompletedWithFindings	2	High/medium-priority findings require review.
Partial	2	One or more collectors encountered errors/limitations; other data may exist.
Fatal failure	1	The process did not finish; this does not imply a persisted report with Status=Failed.

Coverage uses Collected, Failed and NotRequested. Collected with zero rows means the query completed without records in that scope; Failed/NotRequested does not justify that conclusion. Partial takes priority over CompletedWithFindings when collection errors exist. Early failure can occur before a folder/report exists. Output permission/disk failure can leave incomplete files; retain messages and examine integrity before treating output as evidence. There is no atomic transaction across all files.

NotRequested coverage indicates a deliberate choice, such as SkipUserInventory or optional diagnostics not selected, not successful execution of that check. Evaluate overall state, Findings, Coverage and CollectionErrors together. Partial results must not be presented as a complete forest inventory.

19. Lower-volume collection and presentations

To omit users or sensitive-group members:

```
.\Export-ADHealthReport.ps1 -SkipUserInventory -SkipPrivilegedMembers
```

Change the output base and HTML limit:

```
.\Export-ADHealthReport.ps1 -OutputPath C:\AD-Reports -MaxHtmlRows 500
```

Review coverage before sharing counts. Missing collection is not absence of risk. Before presenting, record date, scope, DCs, options, account/permissions and limits. Use findings as review topics and connect recommendations to the organization's change process, not as automatic authorization to make changes.

20. File security and common problems

Reports can expose people/account names, SIDs, memberships, internal hosts, topology and sensitive conditions. Do not publish them to the public repository. Define storage, ACLs, retention and recipients under company policy. The tool does not encrypt, harden ACLs, automatically anonymize or email/upload output.

Unsigned script: inspect Get-ExecutionPolicy -List. AllSigned under MachinePolicy/UserPolicy requires corporate signing procedures. When RemoteSigned permits and origin was reviewed, Unblock-File -LiteralPath .\Export-ADHealthReport.ps1 removes the download mark; it does not override GPO or required signing. Do not indiscriminately switch to Unrestricted/Bypass.

Missing module: check RSAT and terminal version. AD query failure: inspect server, DNS, authentication and permissions. Service/CIM failure: review WSMan and specific rights rather than declaring the DC offline. Missing/blocked DCDiag: inspect administration tools and CollectionErrors. None of these components is installed/enabled by the script.

21. Acceptance, questions and references

Before production, use a representative authorized lab. Compare samples with AD consoles and test denied access, optional collectors, inaccessible domains, empty data and large datasets. Inspect CSV/JSON/HTML, formula protection, presentation limits and file integrity. Confirm intended permissions/diagnostics with the AD team; synthetic tests do not replace acceptance.

Does Completed mean everything is healthy? No. It means the workflow completed under implemented criteria. Coverage limits and unimplemented analyses remain.

Must I be Domain Admin? Not by default for basic inventory. Individual datasets can require specific rights; denied access must remain visible.

Does the script apply recommendations? No. It presents evidence and review items; changes require your approved procedure.

Does CSV retain everything when HTML is reduced? It retains every row that its collector obtained, not data from skipped/failed queries.

Primary references supporting cmdlet use and interpretation. This project is not Microsoft certified or endorsed:

- Schema:
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows-server/identity/ad-ds/deploy/find-active-directory-schema

- Replication metadata:
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/powershell/module/activedirectory/get-adreplicationpartnermetadata

- Replication failures:
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/powershell/module/activedirectory/get-adreplicationfailure

- DCDiag: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows-server/administration/windows-commands/dcdiag

- lastLogon: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/win32/adschema/a-lastlogon

- lastLogonTimestamp: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/win32/adschema/a-lastlogontimestamp

- Group members: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/powershell/module/activedirectory/get-adgroupmember

- Resultant password policy:
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/powershell/module/activedirectory/get-aduserresultantpasswordpolicy

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22. Implemented finding rules

High/Medium are project review priorities, not official Microsoft compliance ratings or proof of compromise. Multiple findings can refer to one account. There is no universal security score.

RuleId	Severity	Observed condition
ACCOUNT-STALE-HINT	Medium	Enabled account with both LastLogonUtc and CreatedUtc older than the InactiveDays cutoff.
UNCONSTRAINED-DELEGATION	High	Enabled account with TrustedForDelegation; computers classified as DomainController are excluded.
KERBEROS-PREAUTH	High	Enabled user with DoesNotRequirePreAuth=True.
PASSWORD-NOT-REQUIRED	High	Enabled user with PasswordNotRequired=True.

RuleId	Severity	Observed condition
PASSWORD-NEVER-EXPIRES	Medium	Enabled user with PasswordNeverExpires=True.
REVERSIBLE-PASSWORD-POLICY	High	Collected policy with ReversibleEncryptionEnabled=True.
REPLICATION-ERROR	High	Nonzero replication result or positive ConsecutiveReplicationFailures.
REPLICATION-FAILURE-REPORTED	High	Failure record with positive FailureCount.
SERVICE-NOT-RUNNING	Medium	Observed service with State other than Running; expected role still needs assessment.

Absence of a finding does not mean every property was evaluated. The tool does not universally determine OS support, each account's effective password quality, all delegation paths or effective privilege. Policy and approved exceptions require responsible-team assessment.

23. Dataset conventions and fields

Normalized dates are ISO 8601 UTC text. Missing/unconvertible dates are empty, not zero dates or evidence of no activity. Absent properties can be null in JSON and empty in CSV. SIDs/GUIDs are text. Selected lists are flattened with semicolons, not exported as restorable AD objects.

Computer categories are DomainController from the DC account bit; ServerHint when OS text contains server; WindowsClientHint for other Windows-prefixed text; Unknown for missing OS; and Other otherwise. These are inventory hints, not probes of the currently running OS.

SPNCount is only the count returned for a user; complete SPN strings are not exported in that column. SupportedEncryptionTypes records the collected attribute value, not algorithms actually negotiated in live sessions. ParentDN is derived from distinguishedName while respecting escaped commas; the parent is not necessarily an OU.

The following headers define this edition's export contract:

Forest

Name, RootDomain, ForestMode, SchemaVersion, SchemaLabel, SchemaMaster, DomainNamingMaster, Domains, Sites

Domains

Domain, QueryServer, DistinguishedName, DomainMode, DomainSid, PDCEmulator, RIDMaster, InfrastructureMaster, Computers, Users, Groups

DomainControllers

Domain, HostName, Site, OperatingSystem, OperatingSystemVersion, IsGlobalCatalog, IsReadOnly, OperationMasterRoles

OrganizationalUnits

Domain, Name, DistinguishedName, ParentDN, ProtectedFromAccidentalDeletion, CreatedUtc, ChangedUtc

ComputerSummary

Domain, Category, OperatingSystem, Count

Computers

Domain, Name, DNSHostName, DistinguishedName, ParentDN, SID, ObjectGuid, Category, OperatingSystem, OperatingSystemVersion, Enabled, LastLogonUtc, PasswordLastSetUtc, CreatedUtc, ChangedUtc, TrustedForDelegation, TrustedToAuthForDelegation, SupportedEncryptionTypes

Users

Domain, SamAccountName, UserPrincipalName, DistinguishedName, ParentDN, SID, ObjectGuid, Enabled, LockedOut, LastLogonUtc, PasswordLastSetUtc, AccountExpirationUtc, CreatedUtc, ChangedUtc, PasswordNeverExpires, PasswordNotRequired, DoesNotRequirePreAuth, TrustedForDelegation, AdminCount, SPNCount, SupportedEncryptionTypes

Groups

Domain, Name, SamAccountName, SID, DistinguishedName, GroupCategory, GroupScope, AdminCount, CreatedUtc, ChangedUtc

PrivilegedMembers

Domain, GroupName, GroupSID, MemberName, MemberSID, MemberClass, MemberDN, MembershipType

PasswordPolicies

Domain, PolicyType, Name, Precedence, MinPasswordLength, ComplexityEnabled, ReversibleEncryptionEnabled, PasswordHistoryCount, MaxPasswordAgeDays, MinPasswordAgeDays, LockoutThreshold, LockoutDurationMinutes, AppliesTo

Trusts

Domain, Name, Direction, TrustType, ForestTransitive, SelectiveAuthentication, SIDFilteringQuarantined, SIDFilteringForestAware

Replication

Domain, DC, Partition, Partner, LastReplicationAttemptUtc, LastReplicationSuccessUtc, LastReplicationResult, ConsecutiveReplicationFailures

ReplicationFailures

Domain, DC, Partner, FailureType, FailureCount, FirstFailureUtc, LastError

Services

Domain, DC, Name, State, StartMode, Observation

NativeDiagnostics

Domain, DC, Test, Status, ExitCode, TimedOut, OutputFile

Findings

Severity, RuleId, Category, Domain, Target, Evidence, Recommendation

Coverage

Dataset, Scope, Status, Rows, StartedUtc, EndedUtc

CollectionErrors

Dataset, Scope, ErrorType, Message